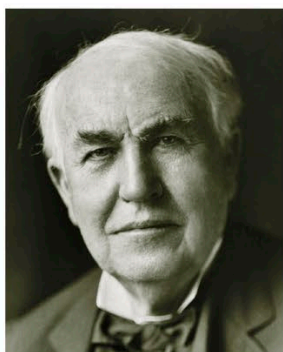


Thomas Edison



The man behind the light bulb, the phonograph, and the movie camera, Thomas Edison's inventions have changed the way people live their lives. Edison built up a huge team of researchers and inventors to help him devise and test his remarkable ideas. He was also always quick to challenge his rivals.



The viewer could watch a film by looking through the peephole at the top of a kinetoscope.

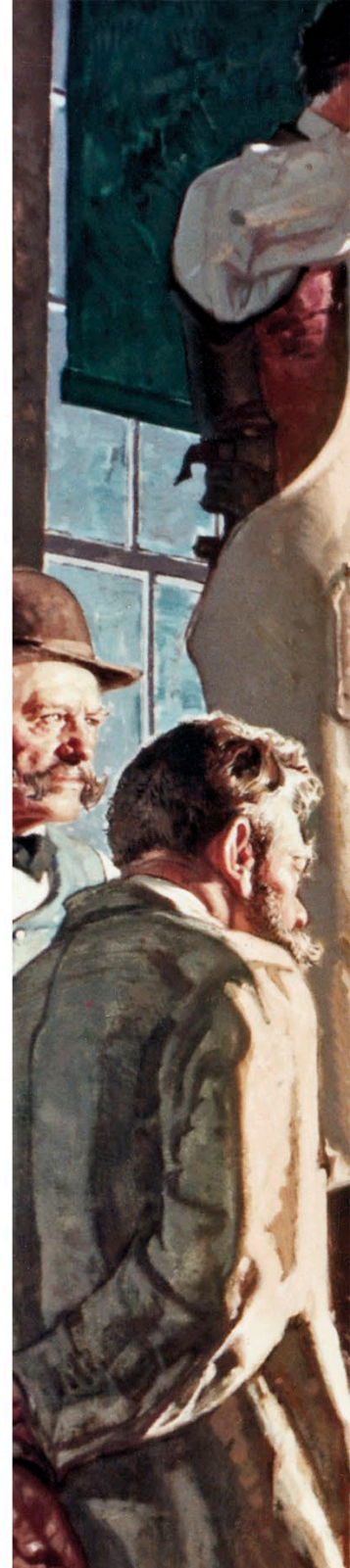
Edison's kinetoscope

MENLO PARK

In 1876, Edison set up a research facility in New Jersey called Menlo Park. In his lifetime, Edison patented 1,093 inventions in the US and another 1,200 worldwide—more than anyone else in the 20th century.

THE INVENTING BUSINESS

For Edison, inventing was a business. As he put it, "Anything that won't sell, I don't want to invent." One early invention that did sell was the kinetoscope. In 1888, Edison filed a patent on this device, which allowed one person at a time to watch movies.



LIFE STORY

1847

Born in Ohio on February 11, Edison is raised in Michigan, where he is mainly taught at home by his mother.

1859

Aged 12, he saves a 3-year-old child from being hit by a train. The child's grateful father teaches Edison how to use a telegraph as a reward. Edison becomes a telegraph operator, inventing things in his spare time.

1869

Edison's first major inventing success is a device that sends out share prices by telegraph. He sells the rights to it for \$40,000, allowing him to become a full-time inventor at just 22 years old.

Edison's stock ticking device

